ILIA SAMARIN

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Tepper School of Business — **Pittsburgh, PA**
B.S. Business Administration, Finance Concentration; Additional Major: Human-Computer Interaction; GPA: 3.62 — *Dec 2027*
Coursework: Machine Learning for Business Analytics, User-Centered Research and Evaluation, Designing Human Centered Software, Interaction Design Fundamentals, Principles of Computing, Statistics & Data Science

University of Pittsburgh, College of Business Administration — **Pittsburgh, PA**
B.S. Business Administration; Minor: Economics; GPA: 3.85 — *2023 - 2025*

PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

Terac — **Remote**
Product, Finance AI — *Sept 2026 - Present*
- Evaluate AI-generated investment banking and private equity deliverables, ranking outputs against analyst-level standards.
- Annotate reasoning and accuracy failures in each output, producing preference data that shapes model training for finance AI.

Perflection AI — **Pittsburgh, PA**
Product Strategy Consultant — *Feb 2026 - May 2026*
- Led five research teams through a five-week discovery sprint for a live-MVP AI golf coaching app, running 11 user interviews.
- Synthesized user insights into a recommendations report that disproved the client's core retention hypothesis.
- Repositioned the product toward beginners and coach-facing use cases, prototyped in Figma with confidence-scored AI feedback.

CMU Business Technology Group — **Pittsburgh, PA**
Project Director, Product Management Academy — *Sept 2025 - Present*
- Run an 18-person product cohort; rebuilt the curriculum around data-driven product strategy, lifting member NPS.
- Defined MVP requirements and roadmap for a Gen-Z career feature against an 80M+ TAM, validated through user research.
- Prioritized the feature backlog and set success metrics, forecasting 5,000+ initial active users at 60% retention.

AfterQuery (YC W25) — **Remote**
Product & Finance Analyst — *Apr 2025 - Aug 2025*
- Defined requirements and success metrics for AI data products with engineering, improving training efficiency by 20%.
- Designed dashboards tracking product performance and customer acquisition trends to inform leadership prioritization.
- Built DCF, LBO, and APV models sizing product scalability, tying financial constraints back into roadmap decisions.

AugCap LLC — **Seattle, WA**
Investment & Product Strategy Analyst — *Jun 2024 - Aug 2024*
- Ran market and competitor analysis for early-stage companies across 5+ sectors, shaping go-to-market and investor materials.
- Built evaluation frameworks for market adoption and engagement that raised deal screening efficiency by 20%.

PRODUCT & RESEARCH PROJECTS

GenAI User Agency Study (ChatGPT)
User Researcher
- Evaluating ChatGPT for college students and young professionals aged 18-24 through heuristic evaluation and usability testing.
- Designing an intervention that raises user agency and reduces unintended GenAI harms, grounded in background research.

Smartwatch Text Entry System
Interaction Designer & Researcher
- Designed a one-thumb keyboard for a smartwatch screen across three build-test-refine cycles and 6 moderated sessions.
- Shipped an n-gram autocomplete engine and suggestion bar, then rebuilt key targets after users mis-hit delete and space.
- Closed testing at 8.5-10.6 WPM with zero uncorrected errors; cut a confirmation step that added taps but prevented nothing.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE & SKILLS

Panther Equity — **Pittsburgh, PA**
Junior Analyst — *Aug 2023 - Jan 2025*
- One of two analysts selected to pitch a high-growth tech stock, building product differentiation into the valuation thesis.

Product: Product Strategy, Roadmapping, Requirements, Backlog Prioritization, Product Metrics, User Research, Usability Testing

Technical: Figma, Python, R, React, Anthropic API, Prompt Engineering, Excel, Notion, Data Analytics

Languages: English, Persian (bilingual)